

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

\$9B cut is a test case for Trump

Move to claw back spending may hold future ramifications

By Kevin Freking
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — President Donald Trump’s request to cancel about \$9 billion in foreign aid and public broadcasting spending is nearing passage in the Senate, an action that would have a tiny impact on the nation’s rising debt but could have major ramifications for future spending fights in Congress.

Spending bills generally need bipartisan support to advance in the Senate. But the legislation before the Senate gives Republicans the opportunity to undo some of the previously approved spending without Democratic support. The measure contains Trump’s efforts to target the Corporation for Public Broadcasting and roll back some of the humanitarian and economic assistance the U.S. provides internationally.

The Trump administration is promising more rescission packages to come if the first effort is successful. Democrats say doing so upends a legislative process that typically requires lawmakers from both parties to work together to fund the nation’s priorities.

The move to claw back a sliver of federal spending comes after Republicans muscled Trump’s big tax and spending cut bill to approval without any Democratic support. The Congressional Budget Office has projected

Turn to *Spending*, Page 4

ComEd relief mostly tapped

Nearly 60K apply in program’s first week

By Robert Channick
Chicago Tribune

As Chicago continues to swelter in record summer heat, the \$10 million ComEd customer relief fund is about to run dry.

Nearly 60,000 customers have submitted applications since ComEd opened the window last week for the one-time grant, which was created to defray rising electric supply charges during peak air conditioning season.

“Based on the high demand seen, we anticipate the fund will soon close, and ComEd will make an announcement once funds are fully exhausted,” ComEd spokesperson Lauren Huffman said Wednesday.

Exelon, the utility’s Chicago-based parent company, is donating the relief money for the fund, which is being administered through Neighborhood Housing Services

Turn to *ComEd*, Page 2

AVOIDING ANOTHER 1995: Chicago creating an index to identify neighborhoods most vulnerable to heat waves. **Chicagoland, Page 2**

CHICAGO CITY COUNCIL

Curfew veto stands

Aldermen come up 6 votes short in effort to override mayor on downtown policy

Johnson casts ordinance to increase police powers as ‘political theater of safety’



Mayor Brandon Johnson greets people after promising to veto the teen curfew on Wednesday at City Hall. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

‘GRANNY FLATS’ STALL: Opponents of an ordinance that would legalize “granny flats” and coach houses blocked a vote Wednesday, stalling the legislation backed by Mayor Brandon Johnson. Aldermen Greg Mitchell, 9th, and Marty Quinn, 13th, used a parliamentary maneuver to prevent a vote at this month’s City Council meeting, and Quinn said he believes the ordinance isn’t likely to pass in its current form. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

By Jake Sheridan
Chicago Tribune

Mayor Brandon Johnson appeared to know what was coming Wednesday morning, hours before backers of an ordinance giving Chicago’s police superintendent power to declare a teen curfew anytime, anywhere failed to override his veto.

Ahead of 28 aldermen voting for the curfew — short of the 34 needed to outmuscle his veto pen — over a dozen aldermen crowded around the mayor at a City Hall event to celebrate him striking the curfew down. It was

a clear sign: Johnson may not have had a City Council majority’s support, but he had enough allies to win nonetheless.

“The easy thing to do would be to play into the political theater of safety. The easy thing to do would be to tell people that if we threaten young people and their families with severe repercussions, that that somehow will make us safer,” Johnson said to the news cameras in front of him and the teen activists who joined the news conference and stood at his back. “It doesn’t make us safe and it doesn’t make our city stronger.”

The Wednesday vote put to rest a monthslong debate over the teen curfew push led by downtown Ald. Brian Hopkins, 2nd. Hopkins charged ahead with the measure in March after two large youth gatherings marred his ward with high-profile Streetworkers shootings.

Hopkins had remained hopeful early Wednesday that he would flip enough aldermen to beat the mayor’s veto, but said regardless he wanted the repeat discussion to be brief.

“We’ve done that ad nauseam,”

Turn to *Curfew*, Page 5

INSIDE



STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Professional softball league taking big swing

Harlyn Detraz, 8, a softball player with the Triple Crown Boomstix, gets her softball autographed by UCLA’s Megan Grant at a recent Athletes Unlimited Softball League doubleheader in Rosemont. The AUSL is the newest swing at professional softball, and guided by University of Chicago graduate and former Marlins General Manager Kim Ng, it continues to grow after three sellouts at its 2,000-seat ballpark. **Chicago Sports**

Mendoza eyes mayoral run

Illinois Comptroller Susana Mendoza declared Wednesday she would not run for a fourth term as the state’s top fiscal officer, but said she was “excited to leave the door open” to challenge Brandon Johnson in what would be her second bid for Chicago mayor. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

Rush reduces gender care

Rush University System for Health is the latest Illinois hospital system to scale back its gender-affirming care for minors amid threats from the Trump administration, “pausing” hormonal treatments to new patients under the age of 18, a spokesperson confirmed Tuesday. **Business**

MONTANO TRIAL

‘Kill me,’ suspect pleaded

Jury shown footage of man who allegedly shot officer in 2023

By Madeline Buckley
Chicago Tribune

In the chaotic moments following the fatal shooting of Chicago police Officer Andrés Vásquez Lasso, the alleged shooter yelled to responding officers, according to body camera footage: “Kill me. Kill me.”

But Vásquez Lasso’s partner that day, Officer Miguel Enciso, instead used his Taser to subdue Steven Montano, 21, who is charged with first-degree murder and other felonies in the March 1, 2023, slaying.

Enciso grew tearful on the witness stand Wednesday as the trial for Montano resumed at the Leighton Criminal Court Building after jurors heard testimony from seven witnesses Tuesday.

“As I got closer to the fence, I could see my partner on the ground bleeding from his face,” Enciso said, looking down as he

Turn to *Trial*, Page 6

